

THE CONFIDENT CONTRACTOR: MASTERING QUOTING & PROFITABILITY IN 48 HOURS

A Tactical Implementation Guide for Residential Contractors

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: YOUR PATH TO PROFIT & PEACE OF MIND

Problem Diagnosis

You're not slow at quoting - you're **paralyzed by pricing anxiety**. The 10 hours you spend on each estimate isn't about the work itself. It's 7 hours of avoidance, second-guessing, and mental wrestling with questions you can't answer:

- Am I too high? (Will I lose the job?)
- Am I too low? (Will I lose money?)
- What if complications happen? (They always do)
- Can I really charge this much? (Spoiler: Yes)

The result? You procrastinate, stress yourself out, delay sending quotes, and even when you finally hit send, you don't feel confident. You feel relieved it's over.

The deeper issue: You don't value your own expertise. You think "I can't believe people will pay for this" because you've always done it yourself. But your clients aren't paying for a bathroom renovation - they're paying for 10+ years of knowledge they don't have, problems they can't solve, and peace of mind they desperately want.

Core Solution Approach

This guide provides a complete system that addresses both the **psychological block** (your mindset around pricing) and the **tactical gaps** (your actual quoting process). You'll get:

- A data-driven pricing framework that eliminates guesswork
- Optimized site visit protocols that capture everything the first time
- Quote templates that sell your value, not just list your costs
- A proven 48-hour workflow that replaces 10-hour anxiety spirals
- Follow-up systems that convert more quotes to paying jobs

This isn't theory. It's a step-by-step playbook built specifically for contractors doing varied residential work (bathrooms, decks, additions, basements) with small crews and relationship-based referrals.

Expected Outcomes

When you implement this system:

- **Quotes delivered within 48 hours** instead of procrastinating for weeks
 - **Feel confident and calm** when you click send, not stressed and uncertain
 - **Higher conversion rates** because you're communicating value, not just price
 - **Better profit margins** because you're pricing for reality, not best-case scenarios
 - **Less wasted time** on tire-kickers who were never serious
 - **Professional positioning** that justifies premium pricing for quality work
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2. MINDSET REFRAMES: UNLOCKING YOUR VALUE & BANISHING QUOTING DREAD

The Real Cost of Undercharging

When you consistently underprice your work, you're not just losing money on one job. You're creating a cascade of problems:

Immediate Impact:

- Working longer hours for less pay than you deserve
- Can't afford better tools or materials
- No budget for marketing or growth
- Living job-to-job with constant cash flow stress

Long-term Damage:

- **Burnout** - You start resenting the work you once loved
- **Reputation erosion** - Underpriced contractors attract problem clients
- **Trapped** - Can't raise prices without losing your underpriced client base
- **Business failure** - 82% of contractor businesses fail due to cash flow problems caused by underpricing

The hidden truth: Every time you quote too low, you're stealing from your future self. You're choosing short-term approval over long-term sustainability.

Value of Expertise vs. Commodity Labor

Here's what you need to understand: **Your clients aren't buying a bathroom. They're buying the absence of problems.**

What they're really paying for:

Your Experience:

- 10+ years of knowing what works and what doesn't
- Pattern recognition that spots problems before they start
- Expertise to handle unexpected complications without panic
- Knowledge of building codes, permits, and proper techniques

Their Time:

- They work 40-60 hours per week at their job
- Weekends are precious family time, not demo time
- Learning to waterproof a shower properly = 100+ hours of research
- Making mistakes costs them even more time to fix

Risk Avoidance:

- DIY bathroom waterproofing fails → \$15,000+ in water damage repairs
- Improper deck framing → structural collapse and liability
- Bad electrical work → house fire
- Code violations → can't sell their house later

Peace of Mind:

- They sleep well knowing it's done right
- No stress about "did I do that correctly?"
- Someone to call if there are issues
- The project actually gets finished

When you quote \$21,600 for a bathroom, you're not charging for tile installation. You're charging for:

- Knowing how to handle tiles that aren't square (like that job where you had to cut them down)

- Preventing water damage that would cost \$15,000+ to repair
- Dealing with complications they don't even know exist
- Giving them their weekends back for six months
- Eliminating the stress of project management

Addressing "Can't Believe People Pay for This"

This psychological block is costing you thousands of dollars per job. Here's the reframe:

Your Thinking (Wrong): "I wouldn't pay someone to do this. I'd do it myself."

The Reality: You DO this for a living. You have the tools, skills, time, and knowledge. Your clients have NONE of those things.

Here's the test: Would you pay someone \$10,000 to do brain surgery on yourself? No? Because you're not a brain surgeon. Your clients aren't contractors. To them, proper shower waterproofing is as mysterious and high-stakes as surgery.

What clients actually think:

- "I have no idea how to do this"
- "I don't want to screw up my house"
- "My time is worth \$75+/hour at my job - I'd rather work and pay someone"
- "The stress of managing this myself isn't worth saving money"
- "I tried DIY once and it was a disaster"

The proof: If clients truly wanted to DIY, they wouldn't be calling you. The fact that they reached out means they've already decided their time, stress-avoidance, and peace of mind are worth paying for.

Risk Absorption and the Problem-Solving Premium

Remember the tile story? Customer bought matching floor tiles in the wrong size. Manufacturer made them imperfect so they weren't square. You had to cut them down and troubleshoot the fitting.

What happened:

- Job took double the estimated time
- You absorbed the cost and complexity
- Customer was willing to pay more, but you ate the difference

- You felt stressed because you didn't price for this scenario

Here's the truth: Complications are not exceptions. They are the norm.

On every job, you're absorbing:

- Discovery of unexpected issues (rot, mold, bad framing, incorrect measurements)
- Manufacturer defects and material inconsistencies
- Design changes clients make mid-project
- Coordination with other trades who are late or do poor work
- Permitting delays and inspector requirements
- Thinking time to solve problems that arise

Your value equation:

Your Price = Materials + Labor + Problem-Solving Premium + Risk Buffer + Peace of Mind

Not:

Your Price = Materials + Labor

When you price correctly, you're building in 15-20% for the **inevitable complications**. This isn't padding. It's reality-based pricing.

The Confidence Loop: How Systems Build Mental Strength

Here's why you procrastinate for 7 hours:

The Current Cycle:

1. Client asks for quote
2. You have no reliable pricing system → **anxiety**
3. You Google estimates, guess at hours, second-guess everything → **more anxiety**
4. You avoid the quote because it feels overwhelming → **procrastination**
5. Deadline pressure forces you to rush it → **stress**
6. You send it without confidence → **relief but no satisfaction**
7. You wait anxiously for their response → **more stress**

The New Cycle (With This System):

1. Client asks for quote

2. You use your Job Cost Bible → **confidence** (it's based on data)
3. You follow your site visit checklist → **clarity** (you captured everything)
4. You plug numbers into your template → **efficiency** (30 minutes, not 3 hours)
5. You review your value communication → **pride** (you're showcasing your worth)
6. You send it feeling solid → **confidence**
7. You follow up proactively → **professionalism**

The difference: Systems don't just save time. They eliminate decision fatigue and uncertainty. Every time you use a proven system and get a good outcome, your confidence compounds. After 5 quotes using this system, you'll wonder how you ever did it the old way.

3. PRICING CONFIDENCE FRAMEWORK: YOUR DATA-DRIVEN PROFIT COMPASS & ANXIETY ANTIDOTE

The Job Cost Bible Template

This is your single most important tool. It's a living document that eliminates the "am I too high or too low?" anxiety by giving you **verifiable, data-backed prices**.

What to include:

A. Your Hourly Rates (The Foundation)

YOUR LABOR RATE CALCULATION:

Desired annual income:	\$_____
+ Business overhead (insurance, truck, tools, marketing, office):	\$_____
+ Taxes (estimate 30%):	\$_____
= Total needed annually:	\$_____
÷ Billable hours per year:	
(assume 1,200-1,500 hours, not 2,000)	÷ _____
= YOUR MINIMUM HOURLY RATE:	\$_____

Example:

\$60,000 (income) + \$25,000 (overhead) + \$25,500 (taxes) = \$110,500
÷ 1,400 billable hours = \$79/hour minimum

Your actual rate should be: $\$79 \times 1.2 = \$95/\text{hour}$

B. Crew Labor Rates

Part-time helper cost to you:	\$25/hour
Your markup (minimum 20%):	× 1.20
= Bill rate for helper:	\$30/hour

C. Materials Pricing

STANDARD MATERIAL MARKUPS:

Small items (<\$100):	Cost × 1.40 (40% markup)
Medium items (\$100-\$1,000):	Cost × 1.30 (30% markup)
Large items (>\$1,000):	Cost × 1.20 (20% markup)

Example:

Tiles cost \$800 → Bill at \$1,040

Shower valve cost \$250 → Bill at \$325

Screws/caulk cost \$50 → Bill at \$70

Why? You're covering:

- Your time to research, order, pick up, deliver
- Storage and handling
- Risk of damage or returns
- Cash flow (you buy it before client pays)

D. Complexity Multipliers

Not all bathroom renovations are equal. Use these multipliers on your base estimate:

STANDARD JOB (1.0×):

- New construction or recent renovation
- Easy access
- Standard layout
- Modern plumbing
- No surprises expected

Base estimate × 1.0

MEDIUM COMPLEXITY (1.25×):

- Home built 1980-2000
- Tight working space
- Some custom elements
- Older plumbing that might need work

Base estimate × 1.25

HIGH COMPLEXITY (1.5×):

- Home built pre-1980
- Major layout changes
- Custom tile work
- Expect hidden issues (rot, old pipes, asbestos)
- Difficult access

Base estimate × 1.5

EXTREME COMPLEXITY (1.75-2.0×):

- Heritage home
- Major structural concerns
- Coordination with multiple trades
- Unknown conditions behind walls

Base estimate × 1.75 to 2.0

E. Project Type Base Estimates

Build these from your historical data. Here's how to start:

BATHROOM RENOVATION (Standard)

Labor hours:

- Demo and prep:	8 hours @ \$95/hr = \$760
- Plumbing rough-in:	6 hours @ \$95/hr = \$570
- Waterproofing install:	8 hours @ \$95/hr = \$760
- Tile installation:	16 hours @ \$95/hr = \$1,520
- Fixtures and finishing:	8 hours @ \$95/hr = \$760
TOTAL LABOR:	\$4,370

Materials (typical):

- Waterproofing system:	\$800
- Plumbing materials:	\$600
- Tile and grout:	\$1,300
- Fixtures:	\$800
- Miscellaneous:	\$300
TOTAL MATERIALS:	\$3,800

SUBTOTAL:	\$8,170
Contingency (15%):	\$1,225
TOTAL BASE ESTIMATE:	\$9,395

Build similar templates for:

- Deck construction (per square foot + complexity factors)
- Fence installation (per linear foot + material type)
- Basement finishing (per square foot + elements)
- Addition framing (per square foot + connection complexity)

Historical Job Tracking Worksheet

For every job you complete, track this data:

PROJECT TRACKING TEMPLATE:

Project: _____ Date: _____
Client: _____ Job #: _____

QUOTED AMOUNTS:

Labor hours estimated: _____ hrs
Labor cost quoted: \$ _____
Materials estimated: \$ _____
Total quoted: \$ _____

ACTUAL AMOUNTS:

Labor hours actual: _____ hrs (____% variance)
Labor cost actual: \$ _____ (____% variance)
Materials actual: \$ _____ (____% variance)
Total actual cost: \$ _____

PROFIT ANALYSIS:

Quoted amount: \$ _____
Actual cost: \$ _____
Profit: \$ _____ (____% margin)
Your hourly rate achieved: \$ _____/hr

COMPLICATIONS:

- ☐ None - went as planned
☐ Minor (List): _____
☐ Major (List): _____

LESSONS LEARNED:

PRICING ADJUSTMENT FOR NEXT SIMILAR JOB:

- ☐ Quote was accurate
☐ Need to add ____% for similar jobs
☐ Need better contingency for: _____

After 3-5 jobs tracked, you'll see patterns:

- "I always underestimate tile installation by 20%"
- "Plumbing complications add \$800 on average in older homes"
- "I'm only achieving \$65/hr instead of my \$95 target"

These patterns become your pricing truth.

Contingency Buffer Calculation Method

Never send a quote without a contingency buffer. Here's how to calculate it:

BASE CONTINGENCY (Always Include):

New construction/simple:	10% of labor + materials
Standard renovation:	15% of labor + materials
Complex renovation:	20% of labor + materials
High-risk/old home:	25% of labor + materials

ADDITIONAL BUFFERS:

Add these on top of base contingency if applicable:

☐ Client is indecisive:	+5%
☐ Major unknowns behind walls:	+10%
☐ Coordination with other trades:	+5%
☐ Tight timeline/rush job:	+10%
☐ Custom/specialty materials:	+5%

HOW TO PRESENT IT:

Option 1: Built into line items (client doesn't see it separately)

- You just price each item with buffer included
- Simpler for client, but less transparent

Option 2: Separate contingency line (recommended)

Subtotal (Labor + Materials):	\$19,350
Contingency Allowance (15%):	\$2,900
(Covers unforeseen complications such as hidden water damage, incorrect existing measurements, or material defects)	
Total Estimate:	\$22,250

Why separate is better:

- Sets expectation that complications happen
- Gives you permission to use it without justification
- If you DON'T use it, you can return it → happy client
- Protects you from the tile-sizing scenario

Market Value & Competitive Edge: Data-Driven Pricing

How to Research Local Competitors Effectively

You need competitor intelligence, but don't obsess over it. Here's how to gather useful data:

Method 1: Online Research (2 hours, quarterly)

- Google: "bathroom renovation [your city]"
- ☐ Visit 10 competitor websites
- ☐ Note their messaging (quality? speed? price?)

- ☐ Check Google reviews - what do clients praise/complain about?
- ☐ Look for posted price ranges (some contractors include them)
- ☐ Note their portfolio quality

Record in a simple spreadsheet:

Competitor | Focus | Price Range | Reviews | Quality Level

Method 2: Industry Networking

- ☐ Join local contractor Facebook groups
- ☐ Attend trade supplier events
- ☐ Chat with suppliers about general market rates
- ☐ Talk to other trades about what they charge

Don't ask: "What do you charge for bathrooms?"

Do ask: "What are typical bathroom budgets you're seeing?"

Method 3: Client Debriefs (The Gold Mine)

When a client chooses you, ask:

"I'm curious - what other quotes did you get, and what made you choose us?"

Listen for:

- Price ranges they were quoted
- What competitors promised vs. what you promised
- What mattered most in their decision

When a client DOESN'T choose you, ask:

"I appreciate you considering us. Mind if I ask what direction you went?"

Often they'll tell you if they went cheaper and regretted it later.

Method 4: Mystery Shopping (Once per year)

Have a friend request quotes from 3 competitors

Review their:

- Response time
- Quote professionalism
- Pricing structure
- Value communication

You're not copying them - you're understanding the market baseline.

Leveraging Competitor Data for Strategic Pricing

Once you have data, use it strategically:

1. Price Anchoring

If typical bathroom quotes are \$15,000-\$25,000:

Your \$21,600 quote lands in the middle-to-upper range.

In your quote, you can reference this:
"Bathroom renovations of this scope in our area typically range from \$15,000 to \$30,000+ depending on quality of materials and workmanship. This estimate reflects our commitment to premium materials and meticulous attention to detail."

2. Differentiation Points

Identify what competitors DON'T offer:

If competitors:	You offer:
- Use basic materials	→ Premium waterproofing systems
- Rush through jobs	→ "Done right" timeline commitment
- Subcontract everything	→ Personal hands-on work
- Poor communication	→ Weekly photo updates
- No warranty	→ 2-year workmanship warranty

Put this in every quote.

3. Value Gap Analysis

Create a mental (or actual) comparison:

LOW-PRICE COMPETITOR:
Price: \$14,000
Materials: Big box store basics
Timeline: "2-3 weeks" (often becomes 6)
Warranty: None
Reviews: 3.5 stars, complaints about follow-up

YOUR SERVICE:
Price: \$21,600
Materials: Premium waterproofing, quality fixtures
Timeline: 4 weeks (realistic)
Warranty: 2 years workmanship
Reviews: 5 stars, praised for quality

VALUE GAP: \$7,600 more = peace of mind, no callbacks, done right

4. The "Too Cheap" Red Flag

If you're consistently 40%+ below market, you're leaving massive money on the table OR you're forgetting costs.

If you're 40%+ above market, either:

- You're overpricing (unlikely)

- You're offering premium services (more likely - own it!)
- Your market research is off

The 5-Minute Confidence Check

Before sending any quote, run through this rapid validation:

THE CONFIDENCE CHECKLIST:

1. Gut Check
"If this job goes sideways with complications, will I still make money?"
☐ Yes → Proceed
☐ No → Add 10-15% contingency
2. Market Check
"Is this price defensible based on my quality and market rates?"
☐ Yes → Proceed
☐ No → Review competitor data
3. Profit Check
"Does this achieve my \$95/hr rate and 10-20% profit on crew time?"
☐ Yes → Proceed
☐ No → Recalculate labor rates
4. Scope Check
"Did I capture everything at the site visit, or am I guessing?"
☐ Captured everything → Proceed
☐ Missing info → Call client for clarification
5. Value Check
"Does my quote communicate WHY I'm worth this price?"
☐ Yes → Send with confidence
☐ No → Add value communication section

If all 5 check out: Hit send. Trust your system.

4. OPTIMIZED SITE VISIT PROTOCOL: BEYOND MEASUREMENTS – DATA, DISCOVERY & DIFFERENTIATION

Pre-Visit Preparation Checklist

24 Hours Before Site Visit:

- ☐ Review initial phone conversation notes
- ☐ Google the address (understand the neighborhood/home age)

- ☐ Print project-specific checklist for this job type
- ☐ Charge phone/tablet for photos
- ☐ Gather tools:
 - ☐ Measuring tape (25ft minimum)
 - ☐ Notepad or tablet
 - ☐ Camera/phone for photos
 - ☐ Flashlight
 - ☐ Moisture meter (for bathroom/basement jobs)
 - ☐ Business cards
 - ☐ Previous quote examples (optional, for reference)
- ☐ Set mental frame:

"I'm not here to beg for work. I'm here to assess if this project is a good fit and provide expert guidance."

Mental Prep:

- You're the expert conducting an assessment
- You're interviewing THEM as much as they're interviewing you
- Your time is valuable - this visit is part of your professional service

The Value-Discovery Interview: Moving Beyond Basic Questions

Most contractors just measure and leave. You're going to have a **strategic conversation** that uncovers what the client really wants.

OPENING (First 5 minutes):

Start with rapport, not business:

"Thanks for having me out. Beautiful home - how long have you been here?"

[Listen. Build connection.]

"So walk me through what you're thinking for this [bathroom/deck/etc].
What's driving this project right now?"

This open-ended question reveals:

- Timeline urgency
- Motivation (necessity vs. luxury)
- Decision-making context

NEEDS DISCOVERY (Next 10 minutes):

Ask these questions for every project:

1. "What's frustrating you about the current [space] that you want to fix?"
 - Reveals pain points (leaks, outdated, too small, etc.)

2. "Help me understand your vision - when this is done, what will make you happiest about the new [space]?"
→ Reveals true desires (not just features, but feelings)
3. "Have you done projects like this before? How did they go?"
→ Reveals past experiences, expectations, potential red flags
4. "Who's involved in the decision-making? Just you, or...?"
→ Identifies all decision-makers (avoid spouse veto later)
5. "What's your timeline looking like? When would you ideally want this started and finished?"
→ Reveals urgency, flexibility, scheduling constraints
6. "Are you getting multiple quotes?"
→ Expected answer: Yes. Follow up with:
"That's smart. What are you looking for as you compare options?"

Listen for: Price focus vs. quality focus vs. timeline focus

BUDGET DISCOVERY (Critical - Don't Skip):

Most contractors dance around budget. Don't. Address it directly:

"Let me ask you about budget. I want to make sure I'm designing something that makes sense for you. Projects like this can range quite a bit depending on material quality and scope.

What range were you comfortable investing in this?"

If they deflect: "We're just getting quotes first."

You respond: "I understand. Let me give you some context. In our area, a [bathroom] renovation with quality materials typically runs between \$18,000 and \$30,000+. Does that align with what you were expecting, or is that a surprise?"

This does two things:

1. Educates them on realistic costs
2. Filters out people with \$8,000 budgets before you waste time

If their budget is 50%+ below your typical range:

"I appreciate you sharing that. To be transparent, a quality renovation with our standards would likely come in higher than that range. I don't want to waste your time with a quote that won't fit your budget.

You might want to consider [simpler alternatives] or [other contractors who work at different price points]."

This saves you from the 7-hour procrastination on a quote they'll never accept.

QUALIFICATION QUESTIONS:

Red flags to watch for:

- ☐ "We're in a huge rush" + unrealistic timeline
 - Likely to be difficult, demanding clients
- ☐ "We had another contractor start but it didn't work out"
 - Ask why. If they blame the contractor entirely, caution flag.
- ☐ Multiple decision-makers who disagree
 - "We haven't decided if we want tile or vinyl yet"
 - Will cause scope creep and indecision
- ☐ Extreme price focus: "We need the cheapest option"
 - Not your client if you do quality work
- ☐ Vague scope: "We're not sure what we want yet"
 - Too early. Tell them to call you when they're decided.

Green flags (ideal clients):

- ☐ Clear vision of what they want
- ☐ Realistic timeline ("We're flexible within reason")
- ☐ Quality focus: "We want it done right, not fast"
- ☐ Respect for your expertise: Asking questions, listening
- ☐ Decisive: Both spouses present or one has authority
- ☐ Reasonable budget expectations
- ☐ Referred by someone you did great work for

Project-Specific Capture Checklists

BATHROOM RENOVATION CHECKLIST:

MEASUREMENTS:

- ☐ Room dimensions (length × width × height)
- ☐ Door width and swing direction
- ☐ Window size and location
- ☐ Vanity space available
- ☐ Shower/tub area (length × width)
- ☐ Ceiling height (esp. over shower)
- ☐ Floor to bottom of window sill
- ☐ Locations of existing plumbing
- ☐ Locations of electrical outlets/switches
- ☐ Distance to main water shut-off
- ☐ Distance to electrical panel

PHOTOS (Take at least 12):

- ☐ Overall room (4 corners)
- ☐ Existing fixtures (toilet, vanity, shower/tub)
- ☐ Plumbing access (under sink, behind toilet)

- ☐ Floor condition
- ☐ Wall condition (any damage, mold, moisture)
- ☐ Electrical panel location
- ☐ Water shut-off location
- ☐ Ceiling (esp. for ventilation)
- ☐ Any complications (tight access, unusual layout)

CONDITION ASSESSMENT:

- ☐ Home age: _____
- ☐ Floor condition: ☐ Solid ☐ Soft spots ☐ Concerns: _____
- ☐ Wall condition: ☐ Drywall ☐ Plaster ☐ Tile ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Evidence of water damage? ☐ Yes ☐ No - Where: _____
- ☐ Ventilation: ☐ Fan present ☐ Window ☐ None
- ☐ Plumbing type: ☐ Copper ☐ PEX ☐ Galvanized ☐ Unknown

SCOPE DISCUSSION:

- ☐ Full gut or partial renovation?
- ☐ Tub to shower conversion?
- ☐ Relocating fixtures?
- ☐ New vanity: ☐ Client supplies ☐ You supply
- ☐ Tile: ☐ Client supplies ☐ You supply
- ☐ Fixtures: ☐ Client supplies ☐ You supply
- ☐ Flooring: ☐ Tile ☐ Vinyl ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Special requests: _____

CLIENT PREFERENCES:

- ☐ Must-have features: _____
- ☐ Nice-to-have features: _____
- ☐ Definite no's: _____
- ☐ Style preference: ☐ Modern ☐ Traditional ☐ Other: _____

LOGISTICS:

- ☐ Other bathrooms in home? ☐ Yes - # ____ ☐ No
- ☐ Home occupied during work? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Pets? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Parking available? ☐ Driveway ☐ Street
- ☐ Access considerations: _____

DECK/FENCE CHECKLIST:

MEASUREMENTS:

- ☐ Deck/fence length: _____
- ☐ Deck/fence width/height: _____
- ☐ Grade/slope conditions
- ☐ Distance to property lines
- ☐ Distance to house (for deck ledger)
- ☐ Height from ground level (deck)

PHOTOS:

- ☐ Entire area (multiple angles)
- ☐ Ground conditions
- ☐ Existing structures
- ☐ Property lines/fences nearby
- ☐ Access points
- ☐ Obstacles (trees, utilities, grade changes)

SITE CONDITIONS:

- ☐ Soil type: ☐ Sandy ☐ Clay ☐ Rocky ☐ Mixed
- ☐ Drainage issues? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Existing deck/fence to remove? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Utilities underground? ☐ Unknown ☐ Marked ☐ Need locate
- ☐ Trees/obstacles to work around? ☐ Yes - Details: _____
- ☐ Permit required? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Need to check

SCOPE:

- ☐ Deck size (sq ft): _____
- ☐ Material: ☐ Pressure treated ☐ Cedar ☐ Composite
- ☐ Railing style: _____
- ☐ Stairs needed? ☐ Yes - # steps: ____ ☐ No
- ☐ Fence height: _____
- ☐ Fence style: ☐ Privacy ☐ Picket ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Gates needed: ☐ Yes - # ____ ☐ No

CLIENT PREFERENCES:

- ☐ Timeline: _____
- ☐ Budget range discussed: \$_____
- ☐ Priority: ☐ Cost ☐ Durability ☐ Aesthetics

ADDITION/BASEMENT CHECKLIST:

MEASUREMENTS:

- ☐ Space dimensions (L × W × H)
- ☐ Ceiling height (basement: measure multiple points)
- ☐ Window locations and sizes
- ☐ Door locations
- ☐ Stairway dimensions
- ☐ Beam locations/heights

PHOTOS:

- ☐ Overall space (all angles)
- ☐ Existing utilities (HVAC, electrical, plumbing)
- ☐ Foundation walls (basement)
- ☐ Floor joists/ceiling structure
- ☐ Any water stains or damage
- ☐ Access points
- ☐ Obstacles

CONDITION ASSESSMENT:

- ☐ Foundation condition: ☐ Good ☐ Concerns: _____
- ☐ Water intrusion history? ☐ Yes ☐ No - Details: _____
- ☐ Moisture level (use meter): _____
- ☐ Insulation present? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ HVAC capacity for additional space? ☐ Adequate ☐ Upgrade needed
- ☐ Electrical panel capacity: ☐ Adequate ☐ Upgrade needed

SCOPE:

- ☐ Full finish or partial?
- ☐ Room divisions: _____
- ☐ Bathroom addition? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Kitchen/wet bar? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Flooring type: _____
- ☐ Ceiling: ☐ Drywall ☐ Drop ceiling ☐ Exposed
- ☐ Special features: _____

COMPLIANCE:

- ☐ Permits required? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Egress windows needed? ☐ Yes ☐ No
- ☐ Code considerations: _____

Photo & Video Documentation Requirements

Why Photos Are Critical:

- Protect you from scope creep ("But it was always like that!")
- Reference during quote creation (no guessing measurements)
- Show before/after to future clients
- Evidence if disputes arise

Photo Protocol:

STANDARD PHOTO SET (Every Project):

- ☐ Wide shots: All 4 corners of the room/area
- ☐ Detail shots: Every fixture